The problem for Chelmsford came when Montagu was finally persuaded to support Curzon's plan. In the structure of authority, the viceroy was subservient to the secretary of state for India and, thus, while Chelmsford could continue to rail against the Home government's plans in Persia, Montagu ultimately had the final say. Once the secretary of state had been brought around to the opinion that it was worth running the risks that Curzon's Persian policy held for the potential beneficial results, Chelmsford had to acquiesce.[98]

Once Montagu had capitulated and Cecil had been brought around, there was little opposition left to Curzon's proposed plans. (It is worth noting that the reason for Cecil's change of heart was not that he became fearful of a Bolshevik threat to Persia but, rather, that he had grown apprehensive over the position of power in which Staroselskii and the Cossack Division would be left should Britain withdraw from Persia.)[99] By August 1919, the Anglo-Persian Agreement was finally concluded. Curzon considered this an important personal achievement, although lamented the fact that others did not recognise this. As he wrote to his wife:

The papers give a very good reception to my Persian Treaty, which I have been negotiating for the past year, and which is a great triumph, as I have done it all alone. But not a single paper so much as mentions my name or has the dimmest perception that, had I not been at the Foreign Office, it would never have been at all.[100]

The agreement allowed for the supply of British advisers for Persia's administrative departments, for the encouragement of Anglo-Persian enterprise for the extension of Persia's railways and roads and for a military commission to assess Persia's military situation (with a view to creating a uniform force, officered by the British and which would ultimately absorb the South Persian Rifles and the Cossack Division). Together with a substantial loan of two million pounds sterling, to be levied on certain concessions, the agreement also stipulated the creation of a joint commission to investigate a revision of the Persian customs tariff.[101] When